

33rd
ANNIVERSARY
SPECIAL

BUSINESS & EC

- 10 Top Global **Takeovers**
- 10 **Biggest** Scams
- 10 Business **Break-ups**
- 10 **Infrastructure** Successes

The battle for control of Dhirubhai Ambani's hard-won empire was the stuff of 24x7 headline news channels, but divisions alone did not define Indian business in the post-liberalisation period. As the government enabled a degree of progress with infrastructural changes, building roads, developing communication networks and facilitating travel, the corporate world flexed its unused business muscle picking up prestige brands like Tetley Tea and global behemoths like Corus. But as India emerged victorious in the merger and acquisition game, there were hurdles on the way as well. In many cases, questions were raised about the capabilities of Indian companies. Sometimes, as in the case of Arcelor, it acquired a racist hue. At other times, it was a question of the fit of an international luxury brand like Jaguar with an Indian company. The Indian economy grew, but not all Indian businesses made the transition from socialist isolation to economic connectedness. Some spilt amicably, others much less so.

MANU CHHABRIA
(SITTING) WITH HIS
BROTHER KISHORE
CHHABRIA

MANU CHHABRIA BURST UPON THE INDIAN CORPORATE
SEEN WHEN HE ACQUIRED SHAW WALLACE IN 1987.